



SQL OF THE DAY

Keep the ties

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StrataScratch · #9905

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THE PROBLEM

Find the first name and target of the employee with the highest target among those reporting to manager_id = 13.

don't drop a tie...

Easy · PostgreSQL

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THE SOLUTION

```
SELECT first_name, target
FROM salesforce_employees
WHERE target = (
    SELECT MAX(target)
    FROM salesforce_employees
    WHERE manager_id = 13
)
AND manager_id = 13;
```





HOW IT WORKS

FIND THE MAX

The subquery `SELECT MAX(target) WHERE manager_id = 13` finds the highest target on that team.

MATCH IT

The outer query keeps every employee whose target equals that maximum.

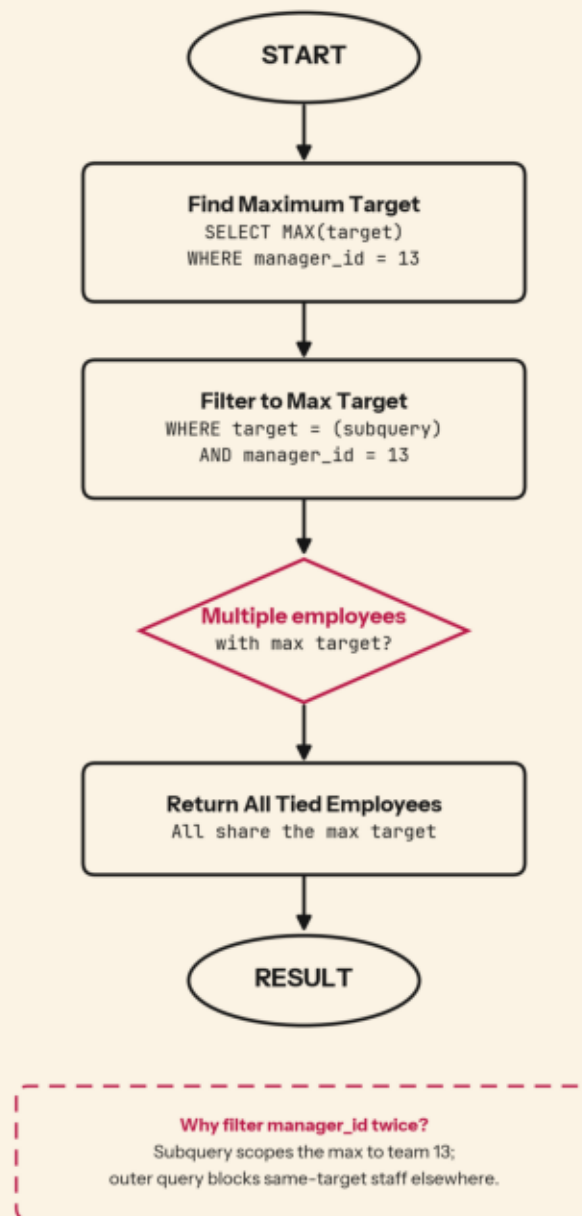
SCOPE BOTH

Filtering `manager_id = 13` in both places stops a same-target employee from another team slipping in.





THE LOGIC





WHY IT MATTERS

01

Performance visibility

See who carries the heaviest quota and may need support.

02

Compensation equity

When several people tie at the top, HR can check that pay and recognition match the workload.

03

Capacity planning

Knowing the ceiling target sets realistic expectations when onboarding new reps or rebalancing the team.





KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Find the boundary with MAX() in a subquery, then match it. This keeps ties.
- 2 When scoping to a group, apply the filter in both the subquery and outer query.
- 3 ORDER BY + LIMIT 1 drops ties; the subquery pattern keeps every top performer.

follow for more SQL problems

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